

DriftDater Dating App: User Manual

Course: Dynamic Web Development 2 (INFO3180)

Assignment: Group Project

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1. User Authentication

Registering an Account

1. On the Homepage click Sign Up in the navigation bar
2. Fill in the registration form with the following details:

Email – must be a valid, unique email address

Username – your display handle on the platform

First Name and Last Name

Date of Birth – used to calculate your age for matching

Gender – select from the available options

Looking For – specify your dating preference (e.g. Men, Women, Any)

Password – choose a strong password (minimum 8 characters recommended)

3. Click Sign Up. You will be redirected to your profile setup page upon success.

If your email is already registered, you will see an error prompting you to log in instead.

Logging In

1. Click Login in the navigation bar.
2. Enter your registered Email and Password.
3. Click Login. You will be redirected to your dashboard.

Logging Out

Click Logout in the top navigation bar at any time. Your session will be ended and you will be returned to the home page

2. Profile Management

Creating Your Profile

After registering, you will be prompted to complete your profile. This includes:

- Profile Picture – upload a photo from your device
- Bio / Description — write a short description about yourself

Interests / Hobbies — add at least 3 interests (e.g. hiking, gaming, cooking). These are used in the matching algorithm

- Gender preference - Select what gender you are interested in.

Click Save Profile when done.

Editing Your Profile

From your dashboard after logging in you can edit below your profile summary.

Update any fields you wish to change, including your photo, bio, or interests.

Click Save to apply your changes. Your updated profile will be visible to other users immediately.

3. Matching System

The matching system is the core feature of DriftDater. It is responsible for connecting users with other compatible users on the platform based on shared characteristics and preferences.

When a logged in user visits the browse page, the system retrieves all other visible user profiles on the platform and scores each one against the current user across four criteria such as gender preference, age range, shared interests, and location. Each profile is then assigned a match percentage and returned to the user in order from highest to lowest compatibility, so the most compatible profiles always appear first. Profiles that the user has already acted on are automatically excluded from the list so they never appear again.

Once a user sees a profile they are interested in, they can either like or pass on it. If they like someone who has also liked them back, the system automatically detects this as a mutual match and creates a confirmed match between the two users. Both users are then notified that it is a match.

Confirmed mutual matches are stored and can be viewed on the matches page, where the current user can see everyone they have matched with along with their profile details. From there, matched users can open a conversation and begin messaging each other. Users who have not mutually liked each other cannot message one another.

The system also tracks the total number of confirmed matches a user has, which is displayed in the navigation bar so users always know how many active matches they have at a glance.

4. User Connections & Messaging

Users can communicate with others through the messaging system after a successful match has been made. To begin a conversation, the user must first match with another user on the platform. Once matched, the user can access the chat interface through the conversations section of the application.

Within the chat interface, users are able to:

- View active conversations
- Send and receive messages
- Review the previous message history with matched users

To send a message:

1. Open the conversations or chat section
2. Select a matched user from the conversation list
3. Type a message into the text field
4. Click the send button to deliver the message

The system ensures that only authenticated users with an existing match relationship can exchange messages. If a user has not matched with another user, messaging functionality will not be available between them.

5. Search & Discovery

The DriftDater application has a Search and Discovery feature that allows users to find and explore profiles that match their preferences and interests. Users can search profiles based on their location, age range and interests. Additional features like sorting (newest, oldest and similar) and filtering help users narrow down searches and discover more compatible matches. Users can also save profiles to their favourite list for quick access later.

How to use:

1. Log into the dating app.
2. Navigate to the Browse tab in the navigation bar.
3. Enter the preferred criteria to search by such as: location, interests or age range.
4. Search happens automatically and then matching profiles will be displayed on the screen
5. Click the Reset Filters button to clear all applied filters and return the search results to their default state.

Saved Favourite Profile

1. Log into the app.
2. Navigate to the Favourite tab in the navigation bar.
3. Users can save profiles directly from the Browse page by clicking the Favourite button on a user card.
4. The profile will display profiles saved by the user.
5. If you want to remove a profile, select the Remove button.
6. The profile will be removed from the user's favourite list.

6. Additional Features

6.1 Notification System

The DriftDater application includes an in-app notification system that keeps users informed about important activities within the platform. Notifications are displayed on the Notifications page and can be marked as read once viewed.

Features

- Match notifications when users receive a new match
- System notifications for important account updates
- Unread notifications highlighted visually
- Ability to mark notifications as read
- Notifications stored in the database for persistence

How to Access

1. Log into the application.
2. Click the Notifications tab in the navigation bar.
3. View all notifications associated with the logged in account.
4. Click Mark as Read to update notification status.

6.2 Report User Functionality

The Report User feature allows users to report inappropriate profiles or suspicious activity. Reports are stored securely in the database for moderation purposes.

Features

- Report users directly from the Browse page
- Popup report form for improved user experience

- Report reason validation
- Duplicate report prevention
- Reports stored in the database for moderation review

How to Use

1. Navigate to the Browse page.
2. Select a user profile.
3. Click the Report button.
4. Enter a reason for the report.
5. Click Submit Report.

The report will be saved and can only be seen and reviewed by administrators.

6.3 Block User Functionality

The Block User system allows users to prevent unwanted interactions from specific profiles. Blocked users are removed from browse results and can later be unblocked if desired.

Features

- Block users directly from the Browse page
- Popup confirmation before blocking
- Prevent blocked users from appearing in browse results
- Dedicated Blocked Users page
- Ability to unblock users
- Duplicate block prevention

How to Use

To block a user:

1. Navigate to the Browse page.
2. Select a user profile.
3. Click the Block button.
4. Confirm the action in the popup window.

To unblock a user:

1. Open the Blocked page from the navigation bar.
2. Click Unblock beside the selected user.

6.4 Dark Mode/Theme Customization

DriftDater includes a customizable dark mode feature designed with a rose and burgundy colour palette to match the application's branding and improve user comfort during extended usage.

Features

- Toggle between Light Mode and Dark Mode
- Theme preference saved using browser local storage
- Dark-themed navigation bar, cards, forms, and popups
- Persistent theme selection after page refresh

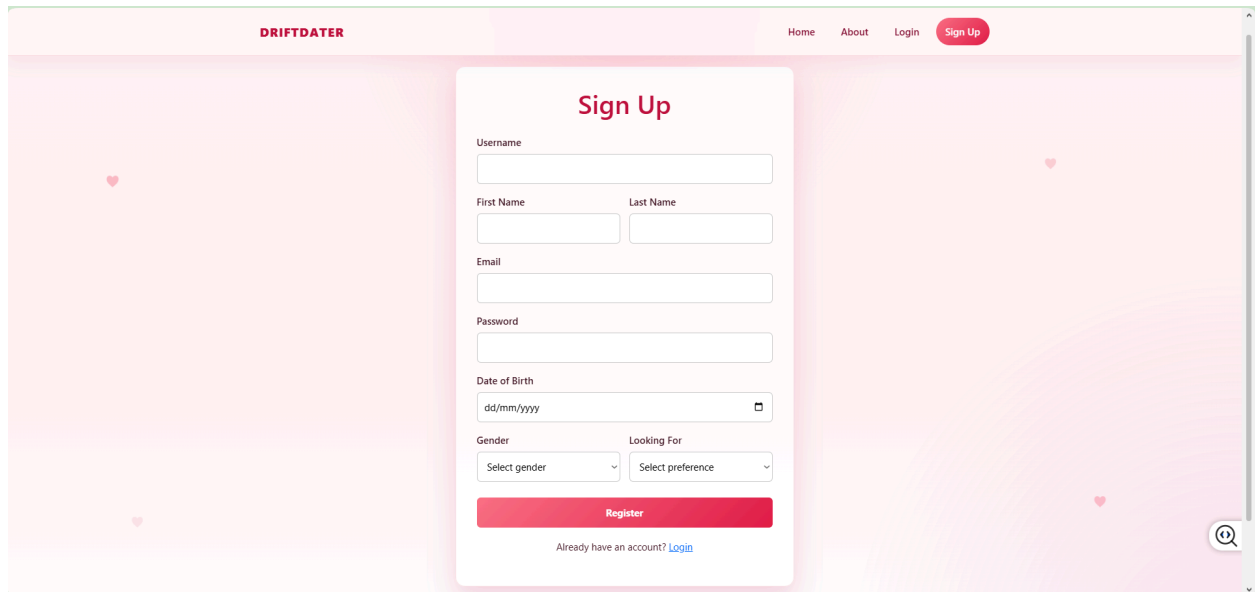
How to Use

1. Log into the application.
2. Click the Dark Mode button in the navigation bar.
3. The application theme will automatically switch to dark mode.
4. Click Light Mode to return to the default theme.

The selected theme preference is automatically remembered for future visits.

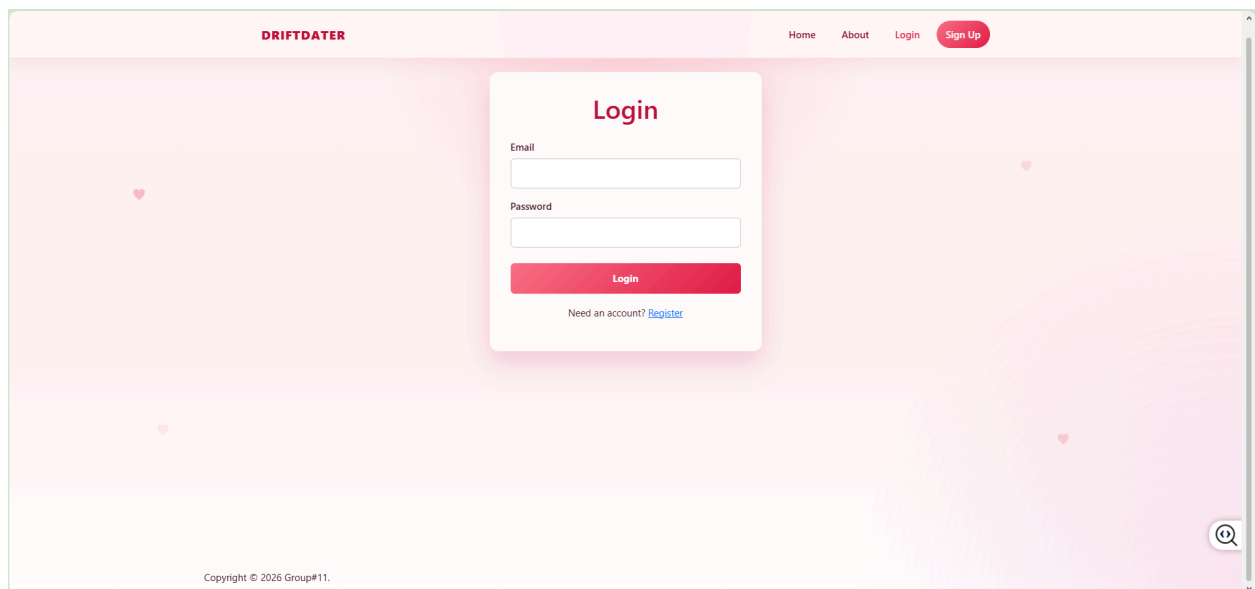
7. Appendix

Register/Sign Up Page



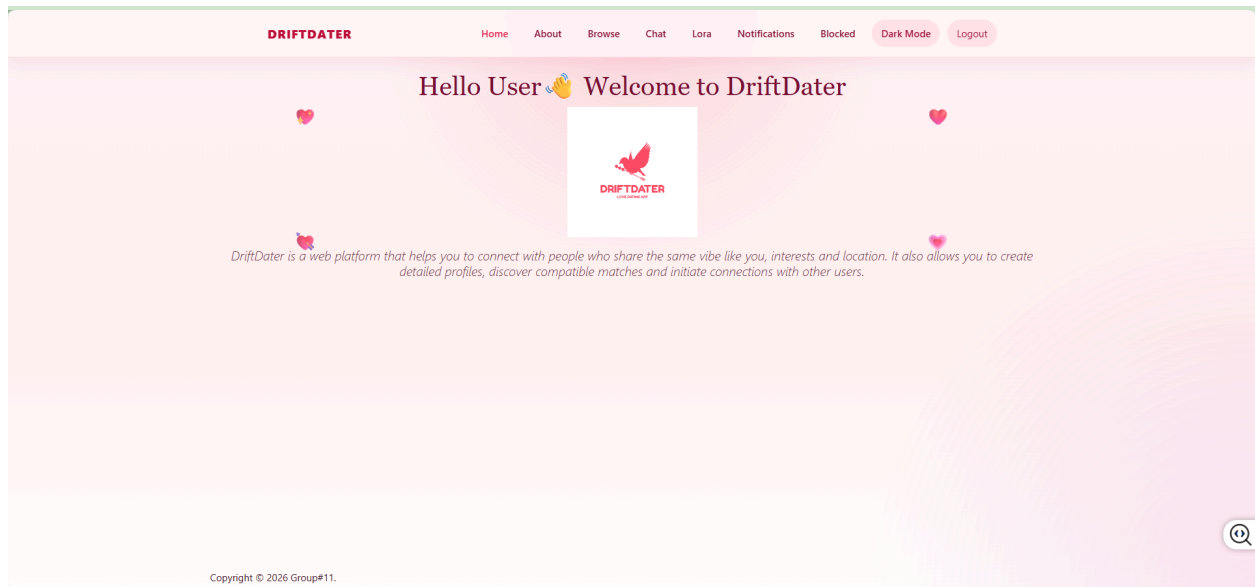
The screenshot shows the 'Sign Up' page of the DRIFTDATER application. The page has a light pink background with faint heart patterns. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the logo 'DRIFTDATER' on the left and links for 'Home', 'About', 'Login', and 'Sign Up' on the right. The 'Sign Up' link is highlighted with a red button. The main content area features a white card with the title 'Sign Up' in red. The card contains several input fields: 'Username', 'First Name', 'Last Name', 'Email', and 'Password'. Below these is a 'Date of Birth' field with a placeholder 'dd/mm/yyyy' and a calendar icon. There are also two dropdown menus for 'Gender' (with 'Select gender' as the placeholder) and 'Looking For' (with 'Select preference' as the placeholder). A red 'Register' button is positioned below the dropdowns. At the bottom of the card, there is a link: 'Already have an account? [Login](#)'. A small circular icon with a question mark is visible in the bottom right corner of the page.

Login Page

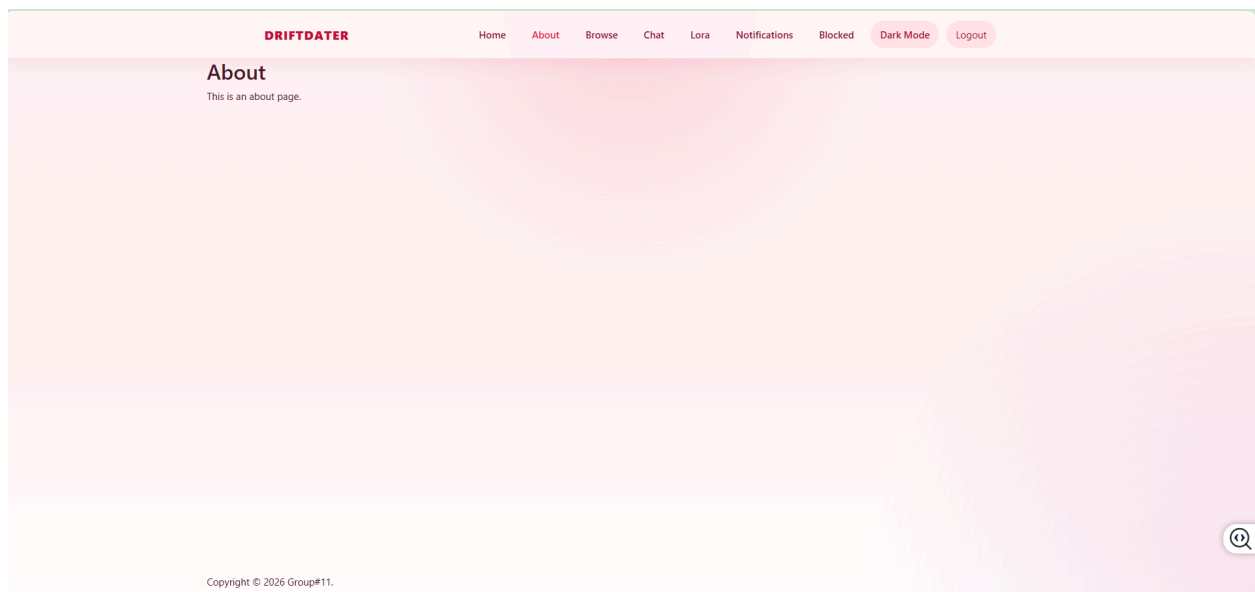


The screenshot shows the 'Login' page of the DRIFTDATER application. The page has a light pink background with faint heart patterns. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the logo 'DRIFTDATER' on the left and links for 'Home', 'About', 'Login', and 'Sign Up' on the right. The 'Login' link is highlighted with a red button. The main content area features a white card with the title 'Login' in red. The card contains two input fields: 'Email' and 'Password'. A red 'Login' button is positioned below the password field. At the bottom of the card, there is a link: 'Need an account? [Register](#)'. A small circular icon with a question mark is visible in the bottom right corner of the page. At the bottom left of the page, there is a copyright notice: 'Copyright © 2026 Group#11.'.

Home Page

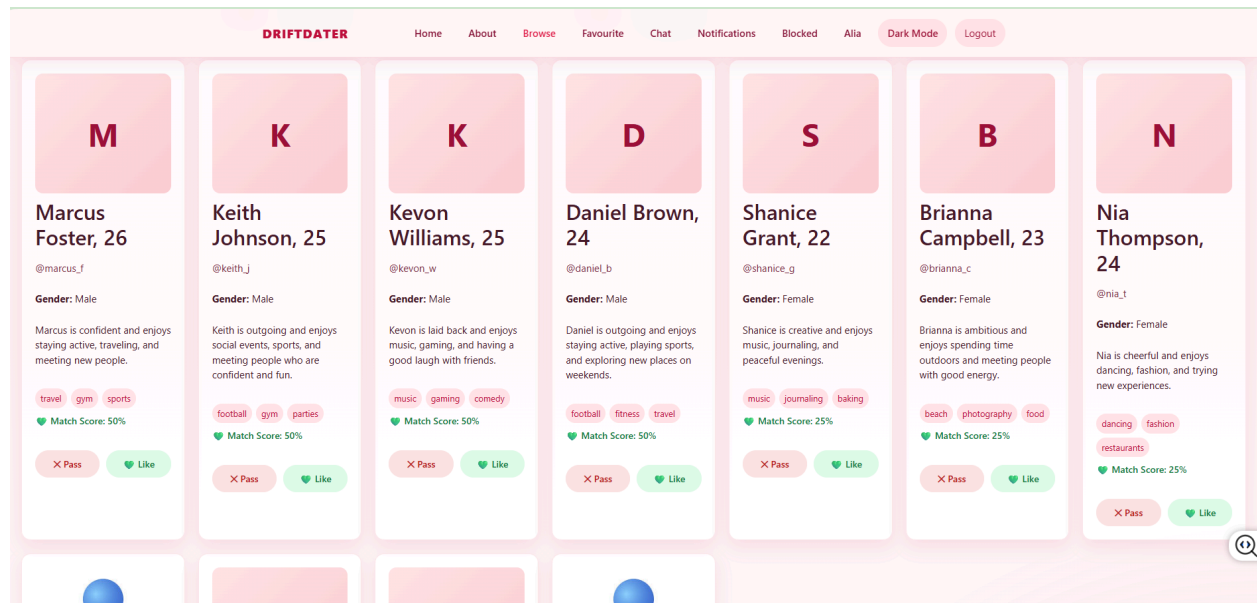
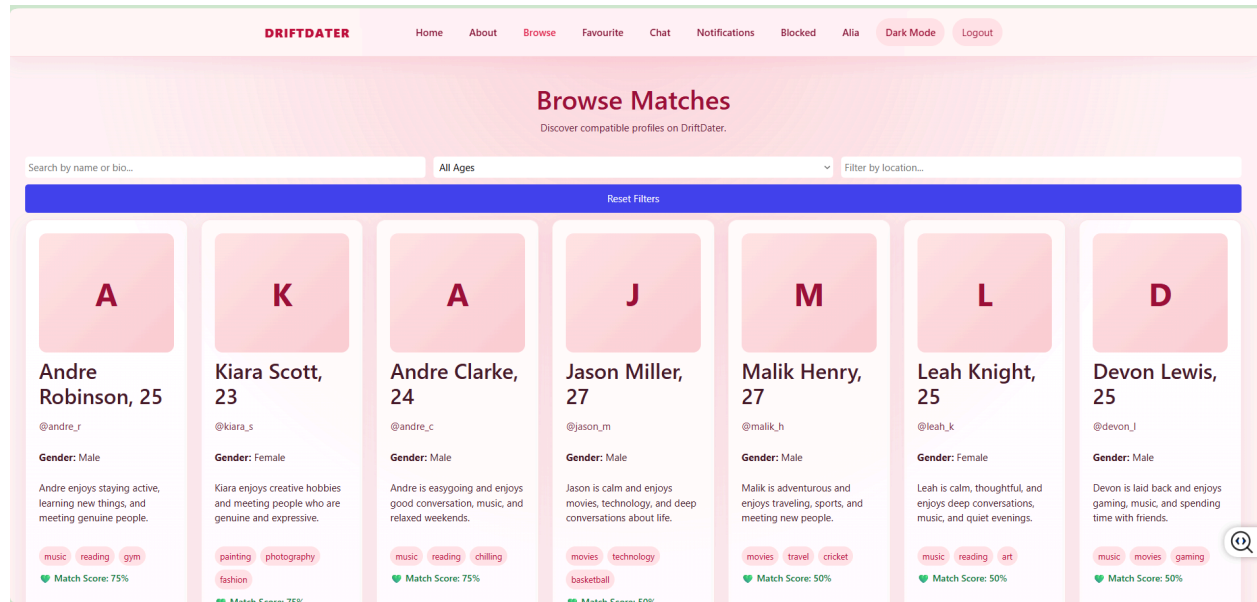


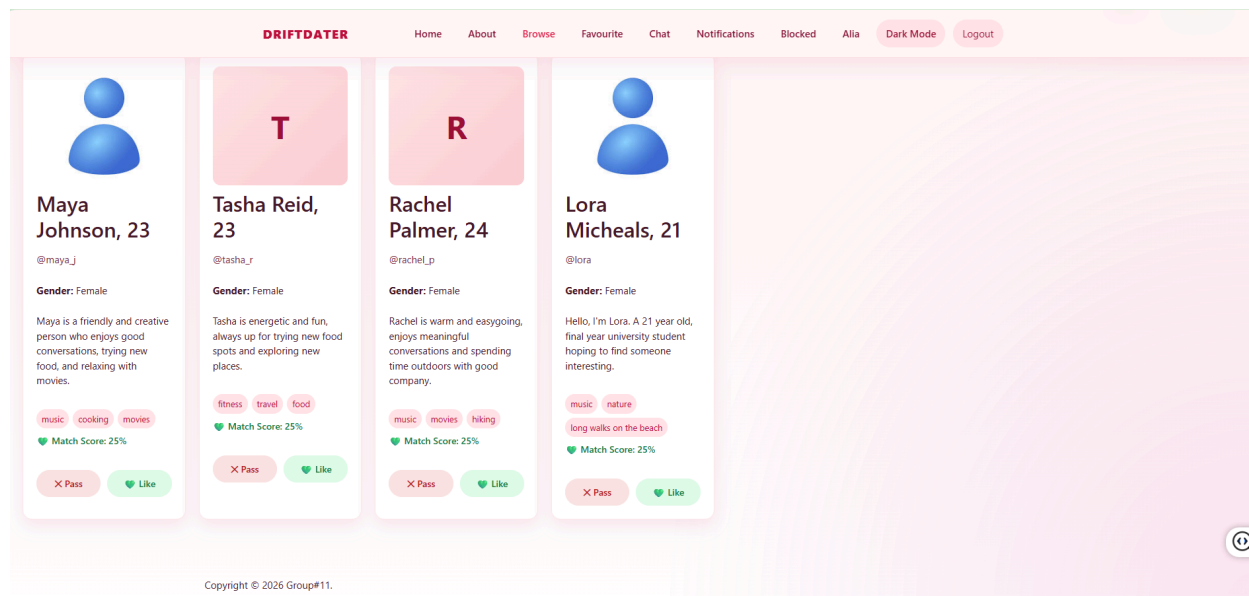
About Page



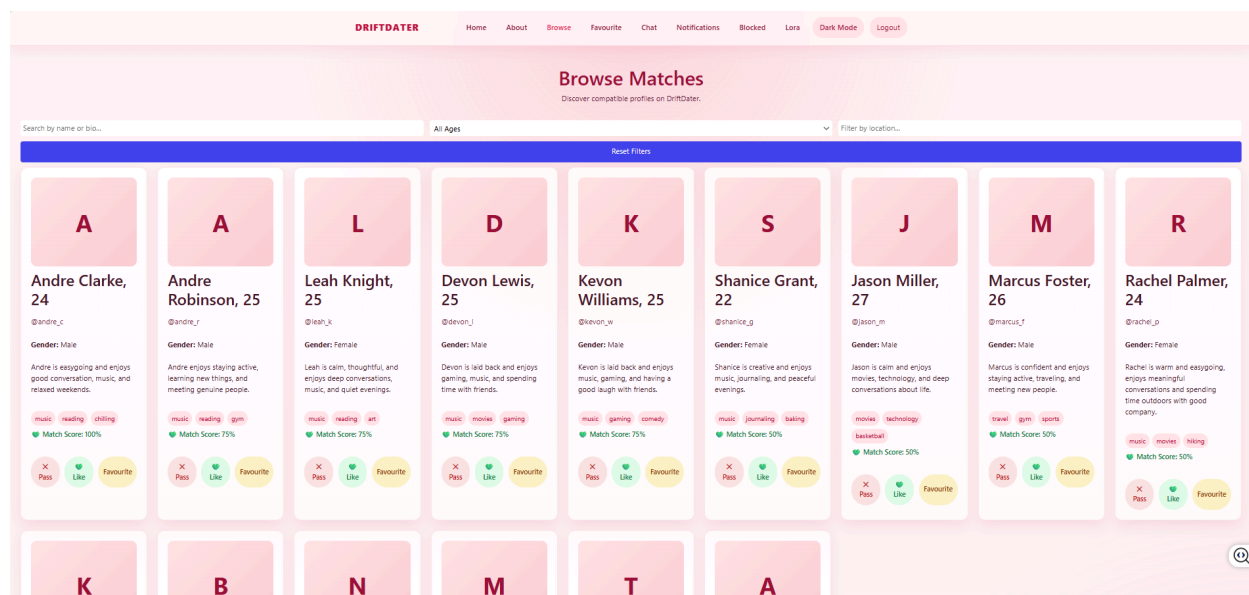
Browse Page

Normal View

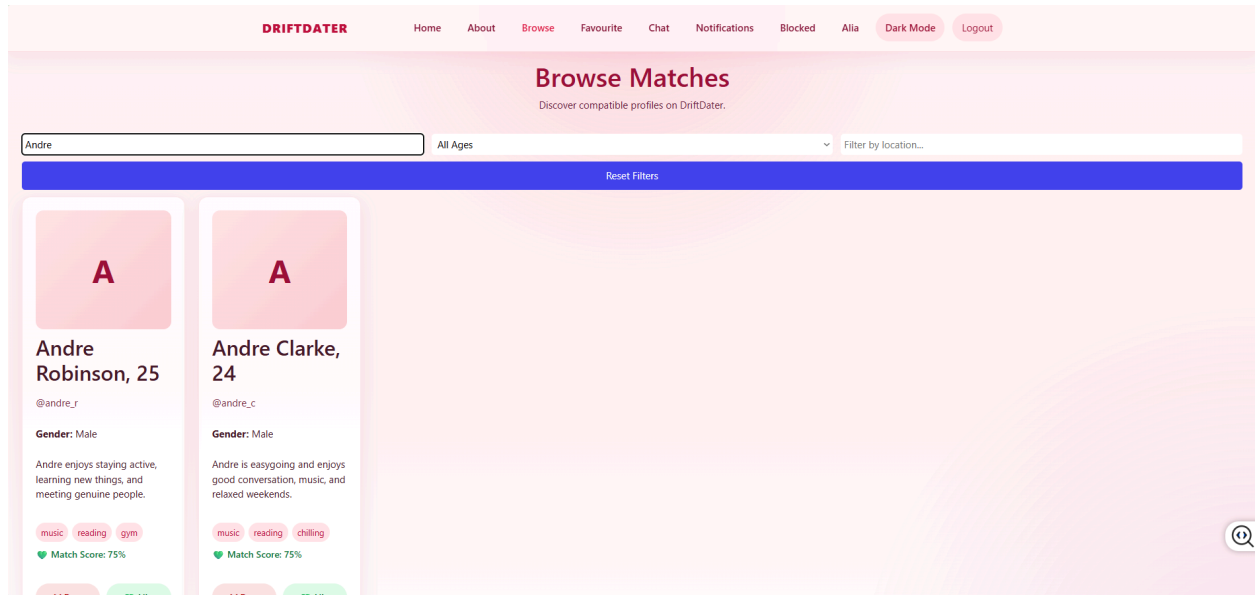




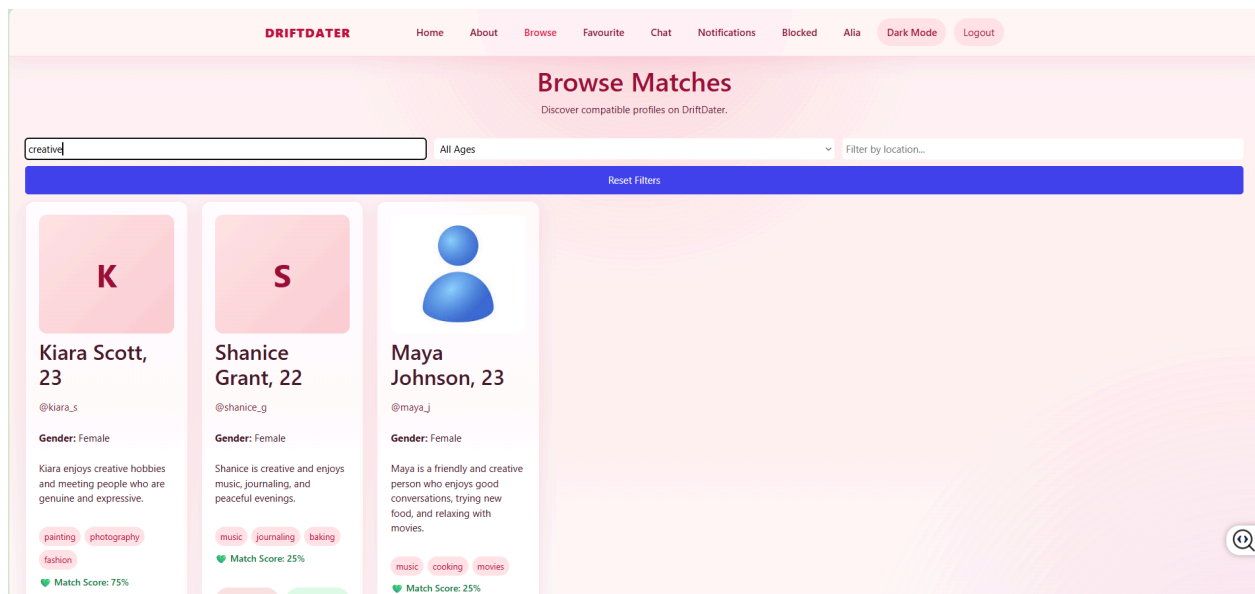
Normal View with Favourite button



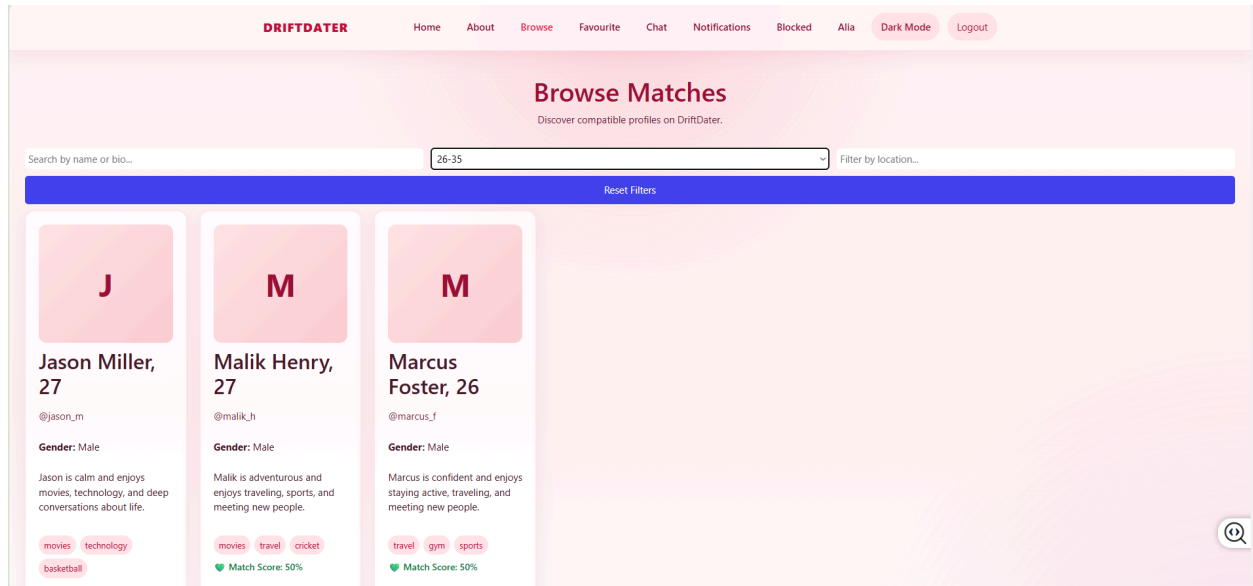
Filter by Name



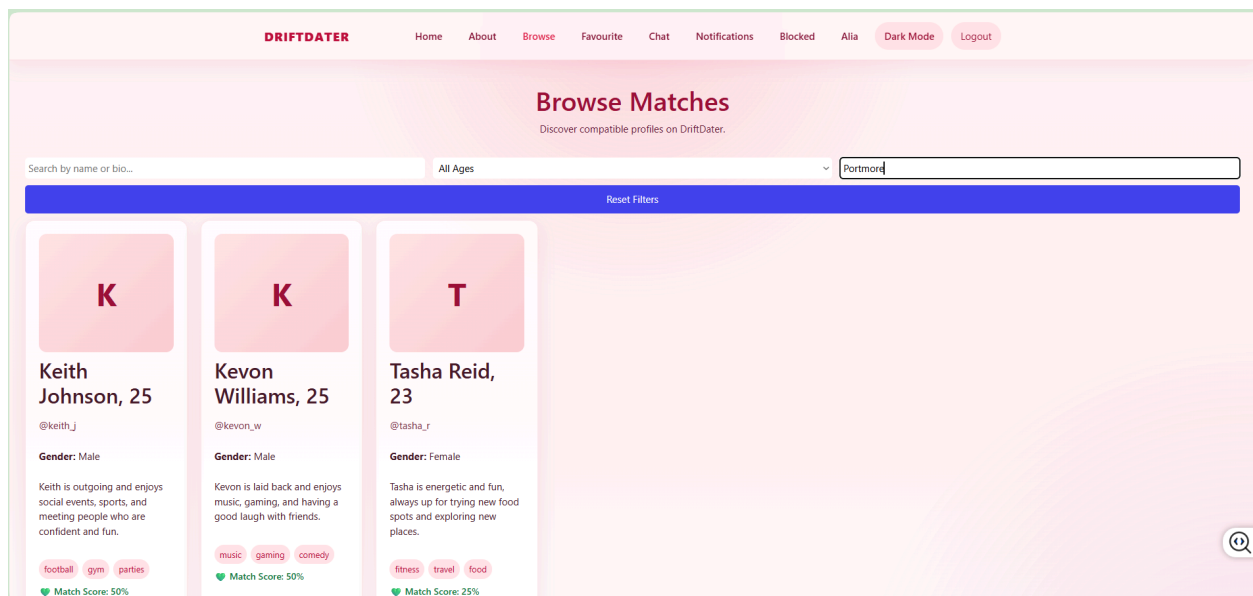
Filter by Bio



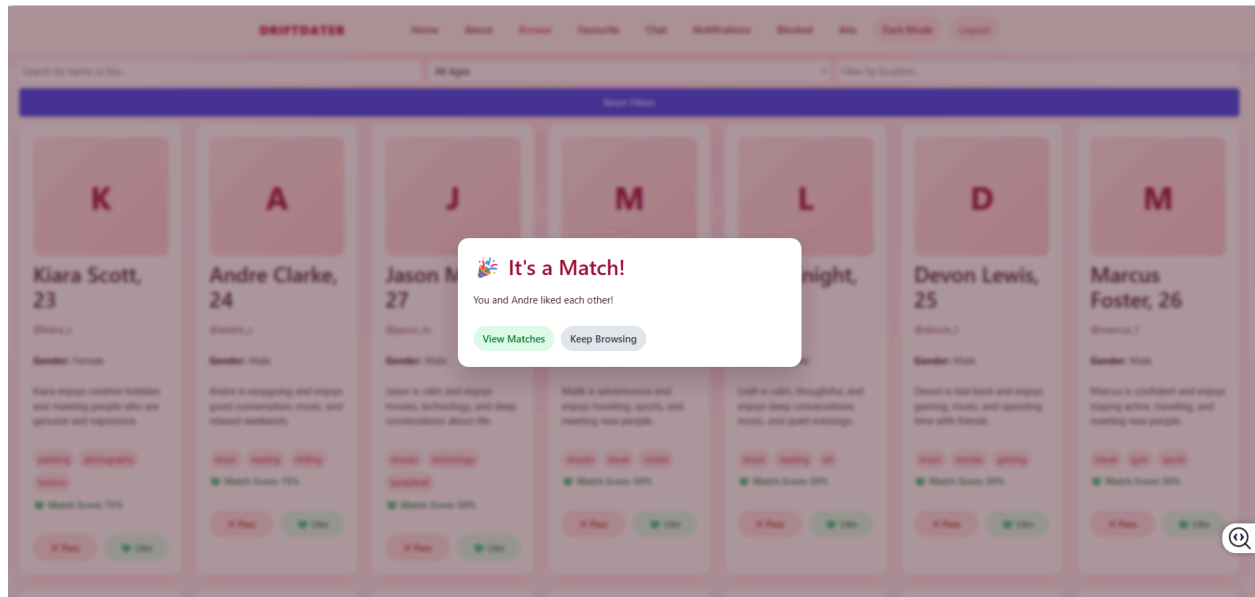
Filter by Age



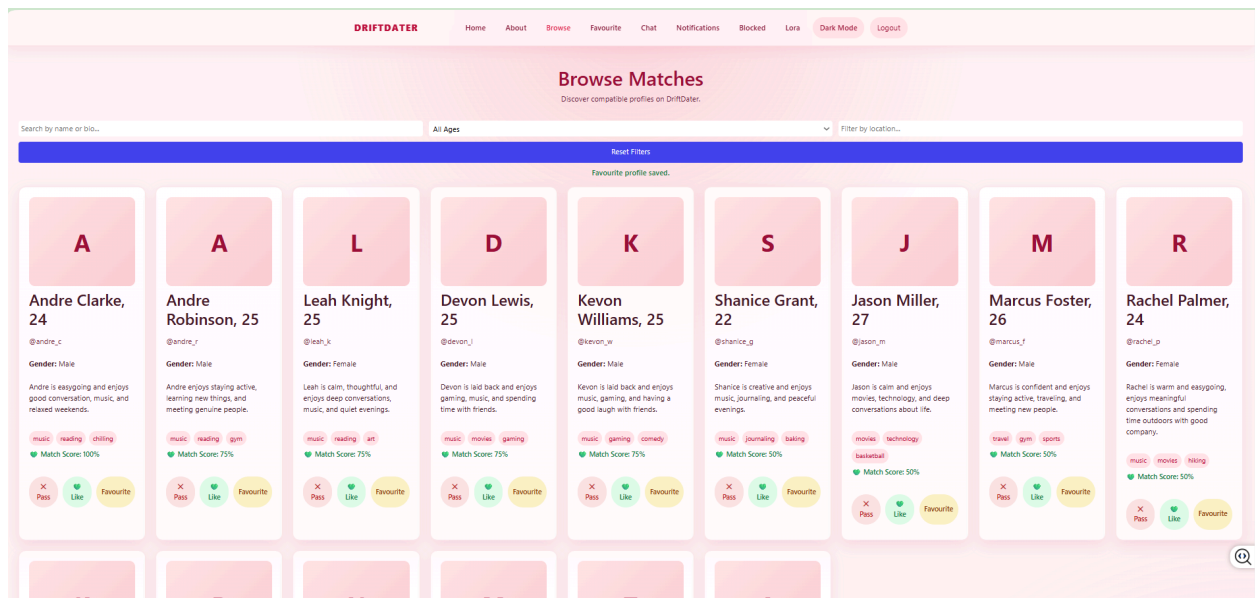
Filter by Location

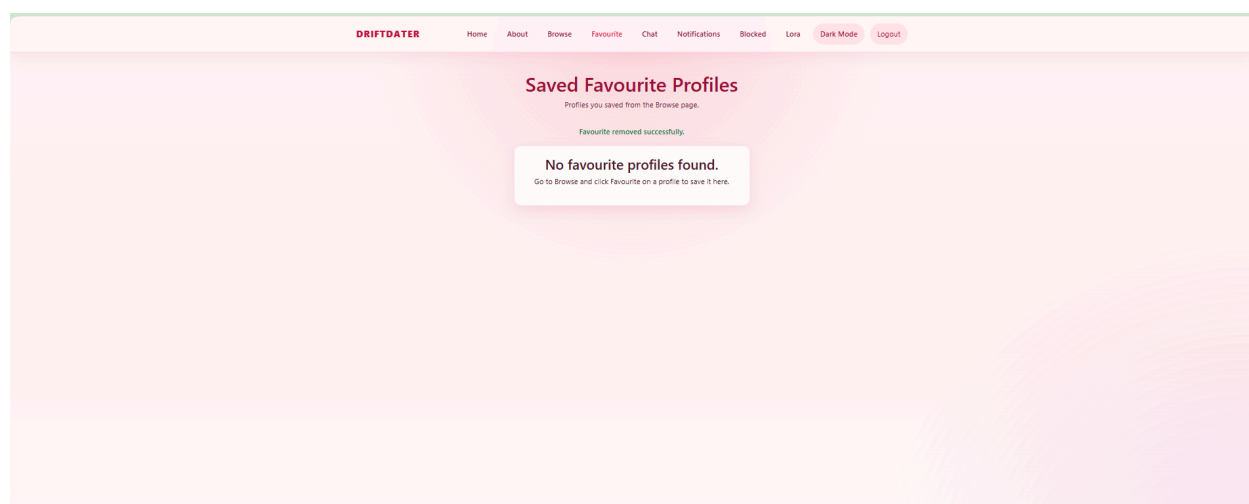
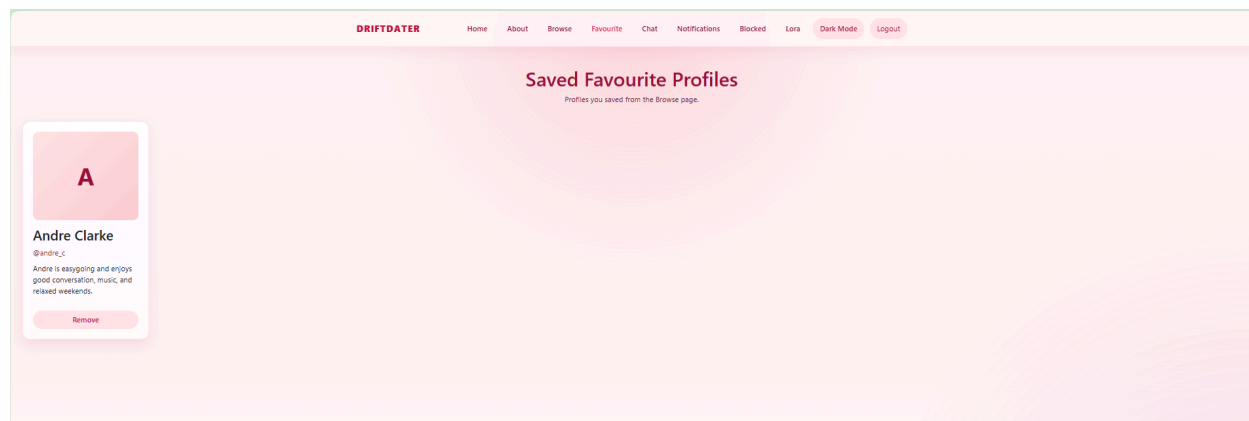


User Match Pop-up Message

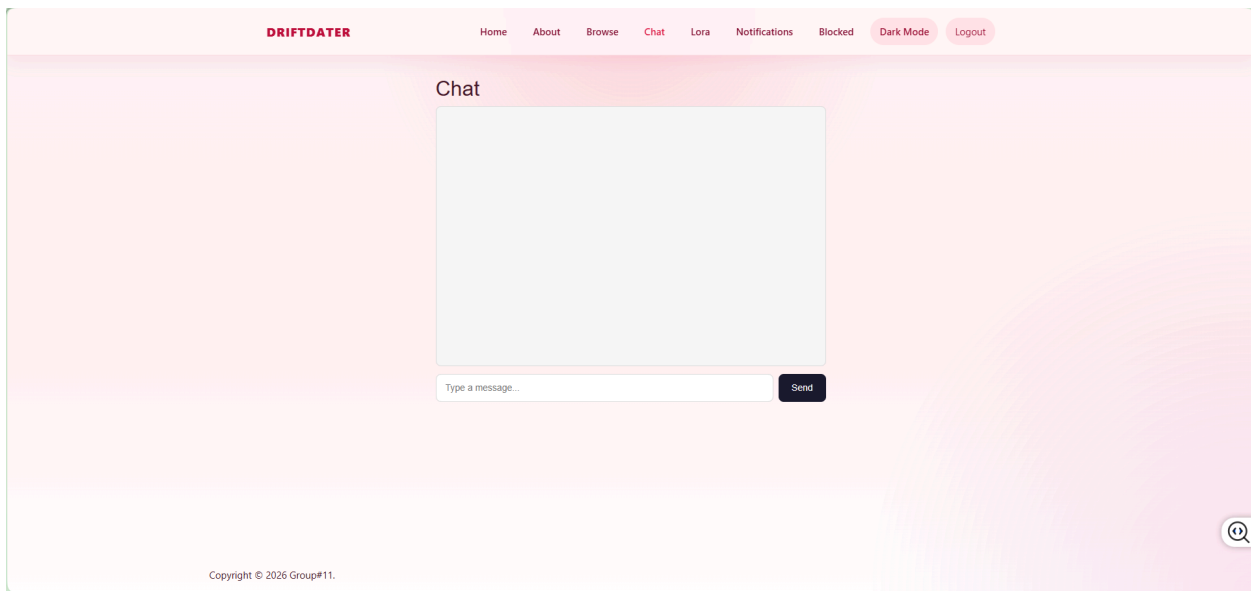


Favourite Page

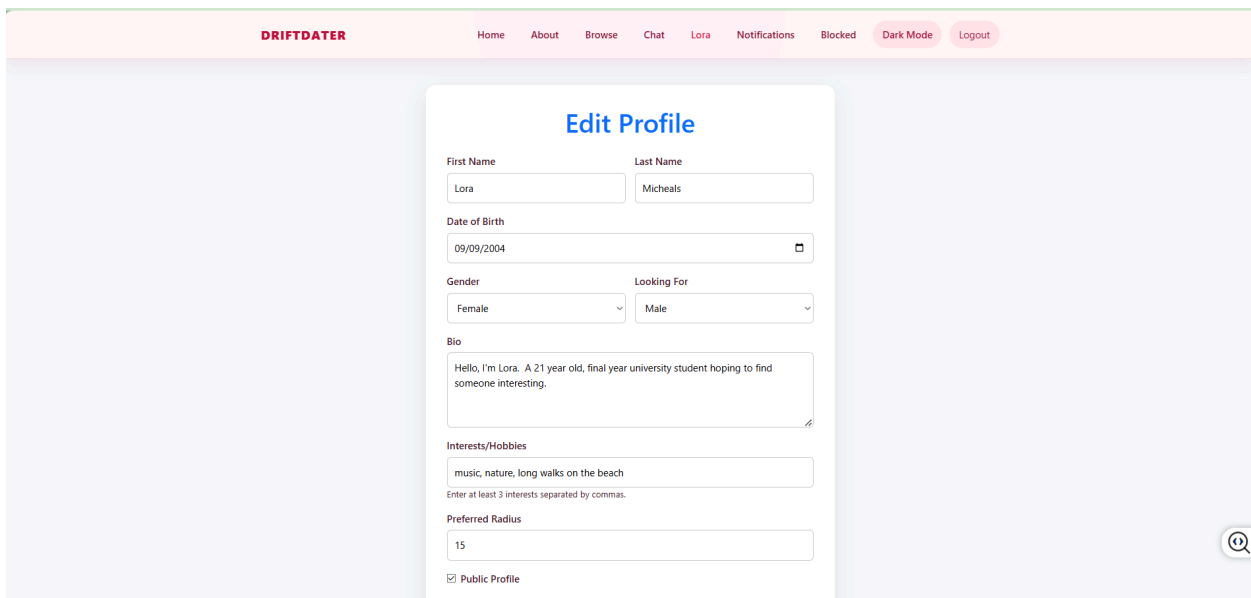


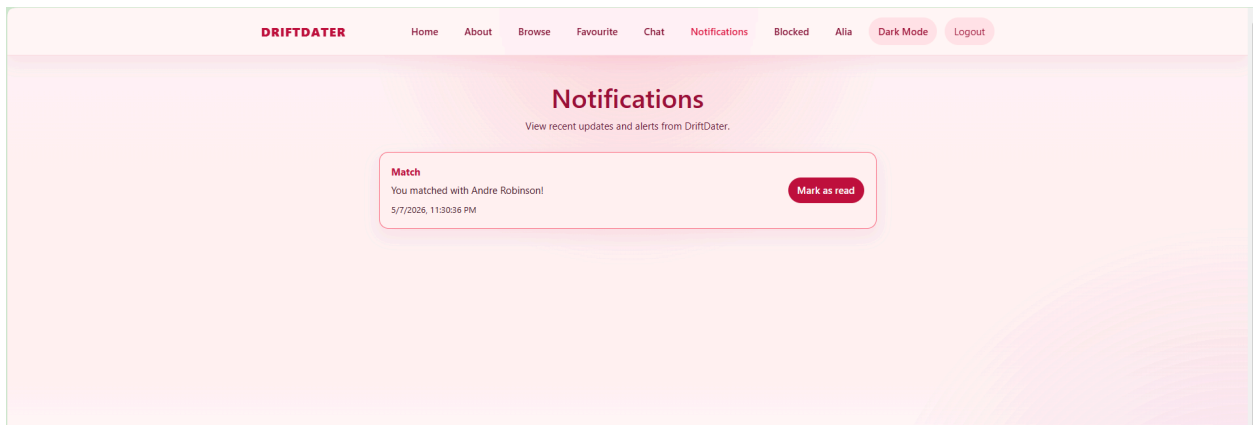
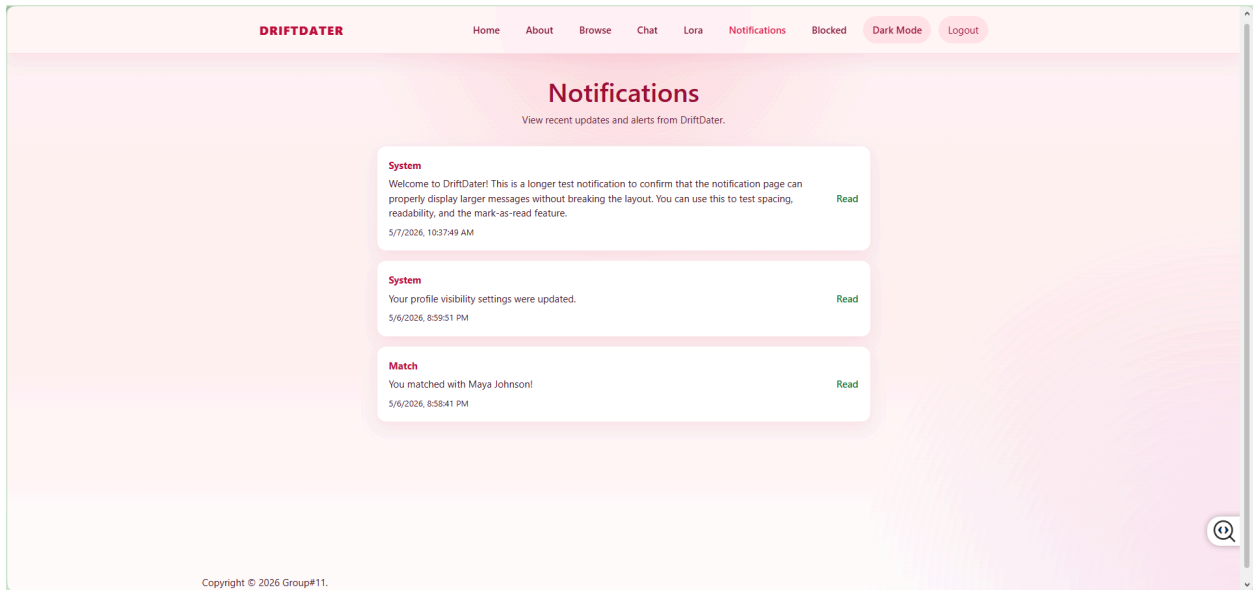


Chat Page



User Profile



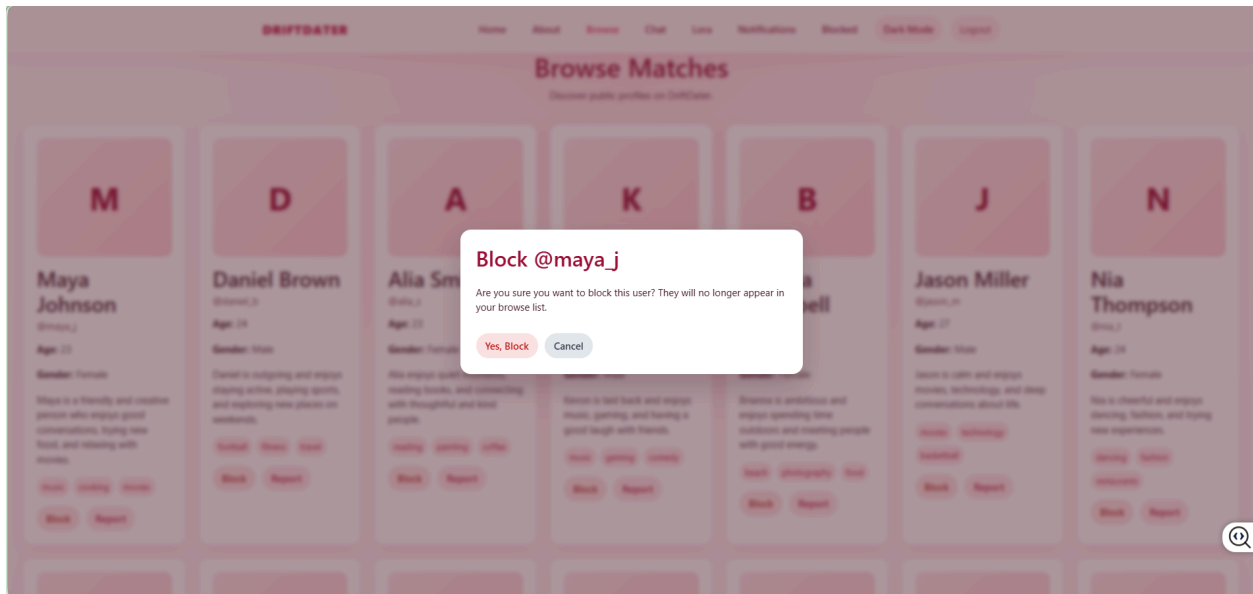


Notification Database

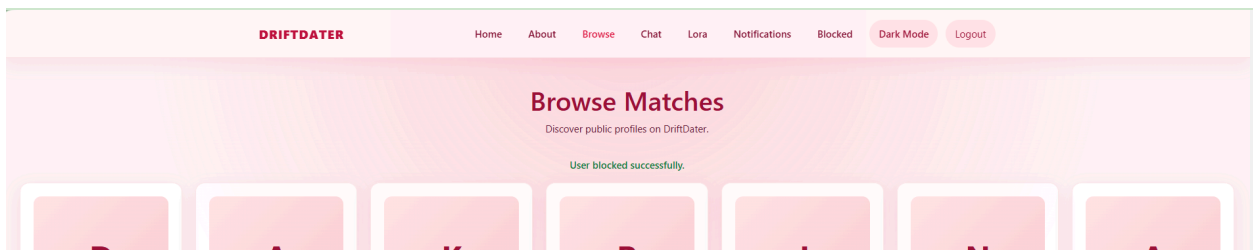
	notificationID [PK] integer	userID integer	type character varying (50)	content text	is_read boolean	created_at timestamp without time zone
1	1	1	match	You matched with Maya Johnson!	true	2026-05-06 20:58:41.545198
2	2	1	system	Your profile visibility settings were updated.	true	2026-05-06 20:59:51.18716
3	3	1	system	Welcome to DriftDater! This is a longer test notification to ...	true	2026-05-07 10:37:49.399769
4	4	1	match	You matched with Daniel Brown!	false	2026-05-07 23:09:08.747127
5	5	3	match	You matched with Lora Micheals!	false	2026-05-07 23:09:08.747127
6	6	4	match	You matched with Andre Robinson!	false	2026-05-07 23:30:36.961628
7	7	9	match	You matched with Alia Smith!	false	2026-05-07 23:30:36.961628

Block User Functionality

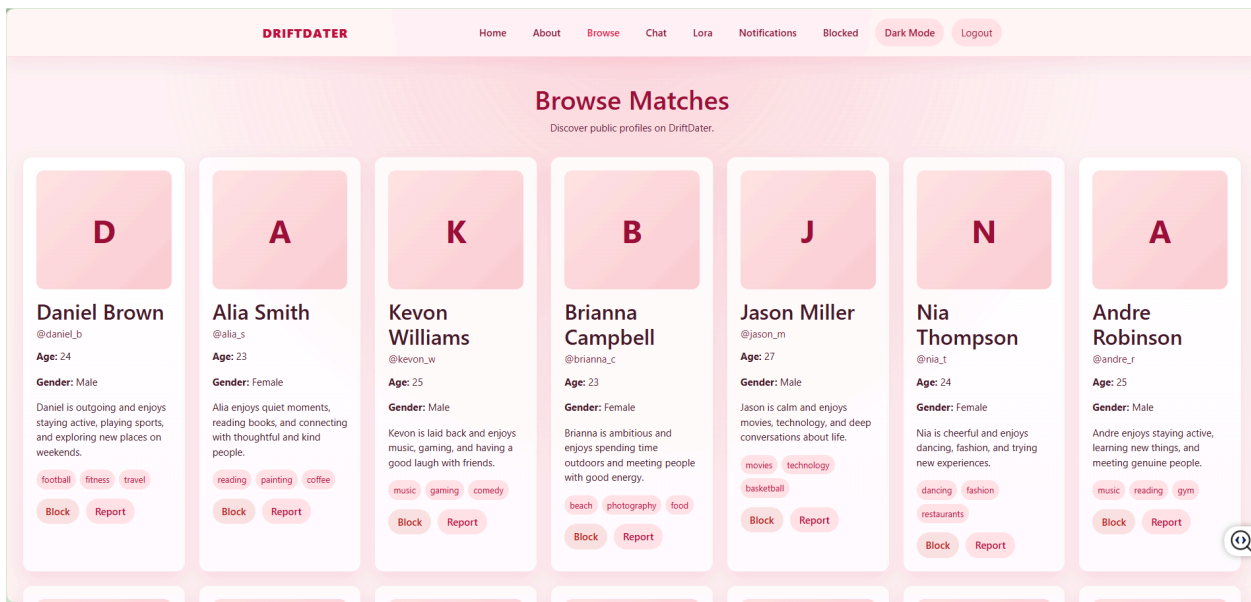
Block Pop-up



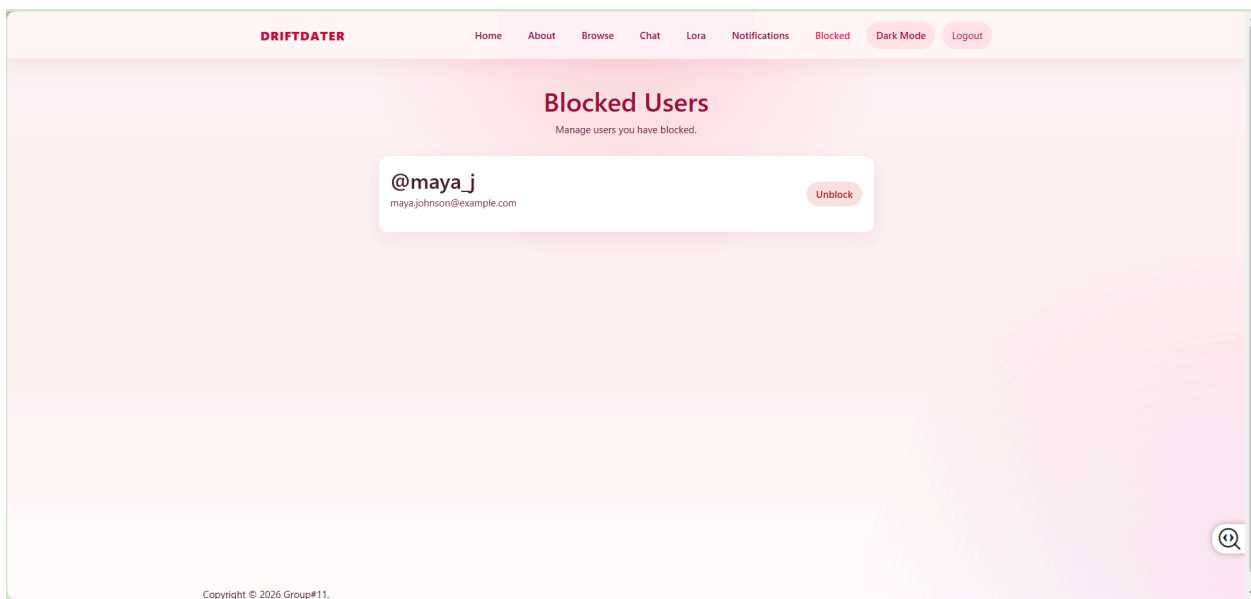
Successful Block Message



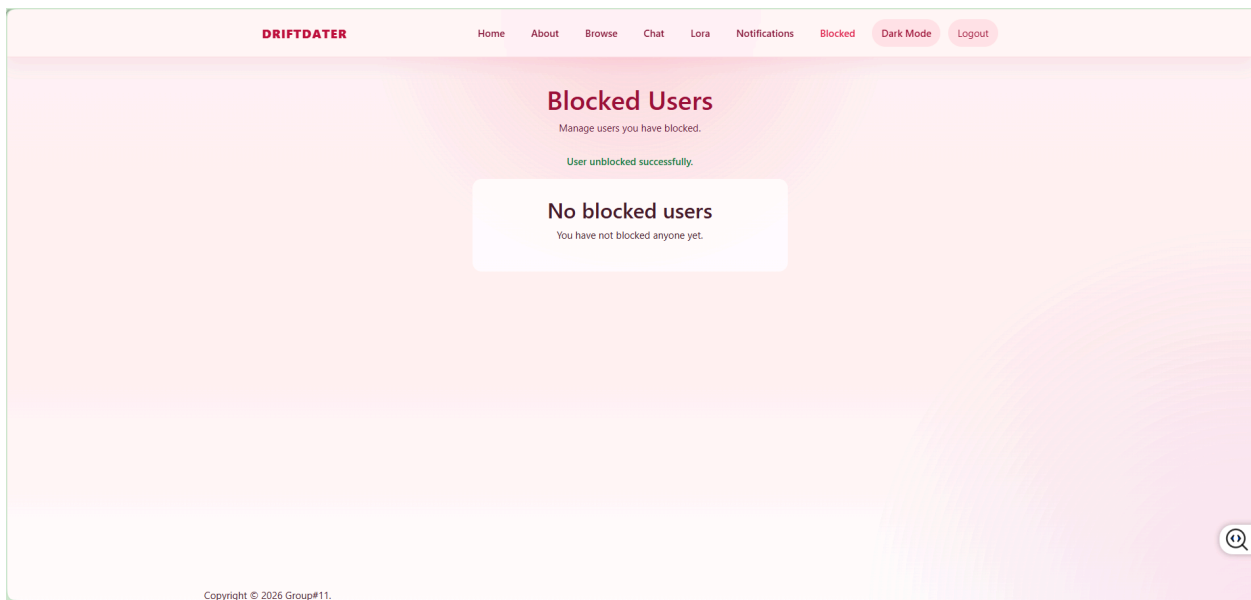
Showing user being gone from Browse Tab



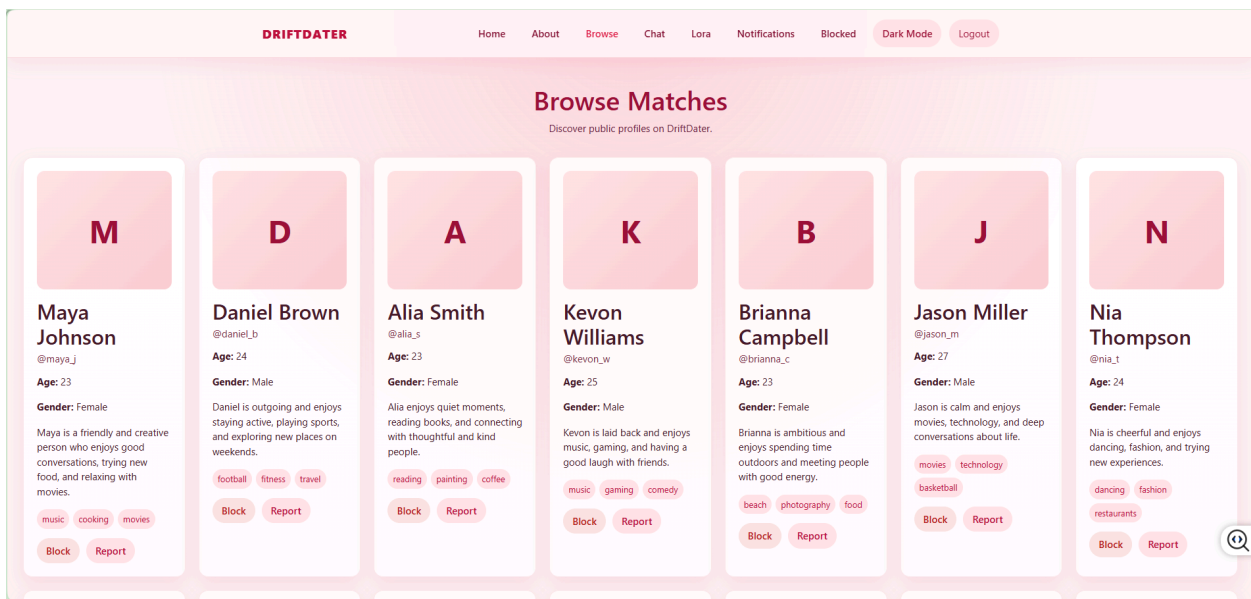
Block Tab



UnBlock User

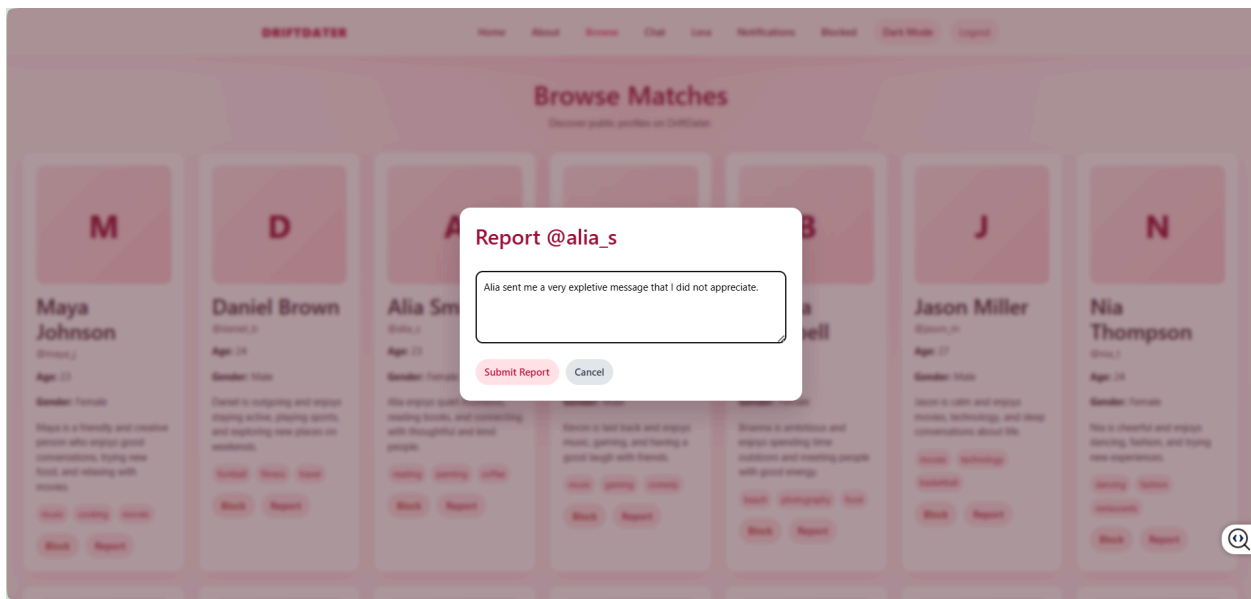


Showing user returning to Browse Tab

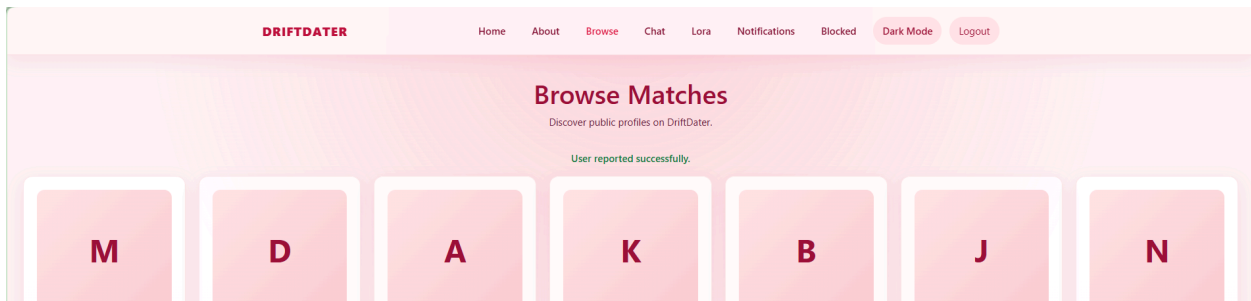


Report User Functionality

Report Pop-up



Successful Report Message

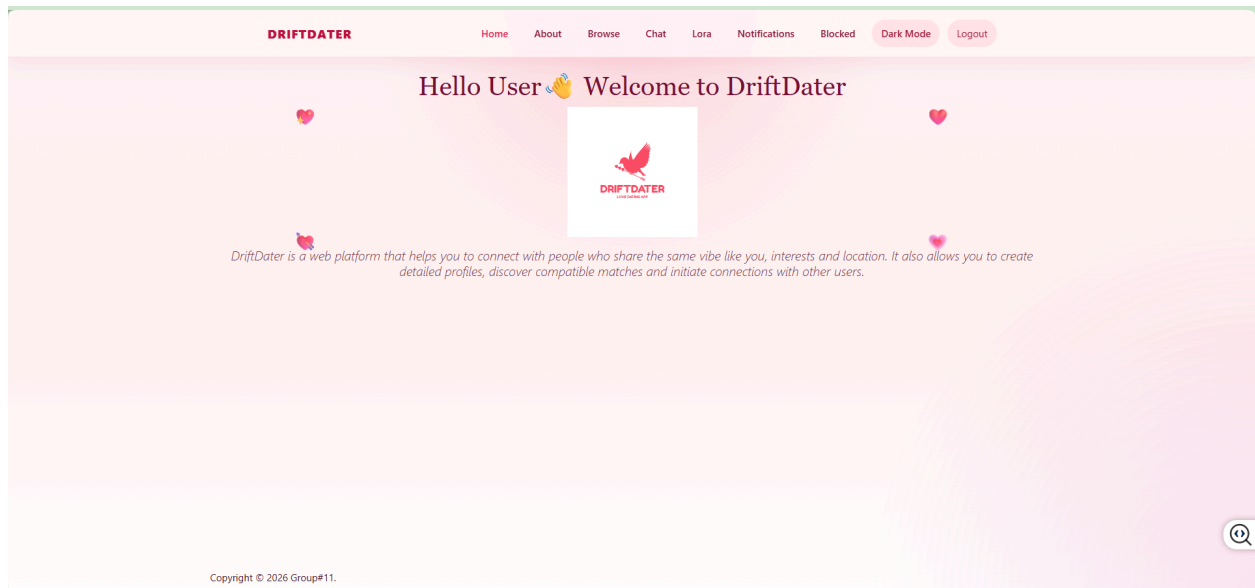


Report Database

	reportID [PK] integer	reporterID integer	reportedID integer	reason text	created_at timestamp without time zone
1	1	1	2	Said something very inappropriate to me	2026-05-06 20:54:49.74391
2	2	1	3	Said something inappropriate.	2026-05-06 21:55:04.073079
3	3	1	4	Alia sent me a very expletive message that I did not appreci...	2026-05-07 10:34:53.889473

Dark Mode Customization (Applied to all Pages when selected)

Light Mode Home Page



Dark Mode Home Page

